PBTABLE · RELEASE NOTE FOR CLUB COMMITTEES

THE THREE-HOUR RULE

Three hours before a session starts, the roster is final: no new bookings, and no freed spot handed to the waiting list. Nobody is charged for a night they have no chance of reaching, and the line-up you build stops changing under you.

LIVE FROM	APPLIES TO	ACTION NEEDED
12 September 2026	Gloucestershire, Swindon	Tell your hosts

> From **3 hours before the start**, the session is locked: **no new bookings**, and a spot that frees up is **not given to the waiting list**. Anyone who cancels after that **loses their booking fee**. Outside those 3 hours, nothing has changed.

WHY WE CHANGED IT

Someone cancels at 18:30 for a 19:30 start. The first person on the waiting list was booked in and their credit taken — and the only way they found out was an email, an hour before the session, which most people will not read in time. They paid for a night they never chose and could not get to.

BEFORE

Cancellation at 18:30 → next person on the list is **booked and charged** at 18:30, and told by email. They miss it. The club keeps the money.

NOW

Cancellation at 18:30 → **nobody is promoted and nobody is charged**. The spot is released and stays open for anyone who can genuinely still make it.

The same guard covers every route a spot can change hands: a member cancelling, an admin removing a player from the night, and an admin raising the capacity of a session that already has a queue.

WHY LOCK THE WHOLE SESSION

Because the line-up has to be built from a list that has stopped changing. Once the lock starts nobody new can book or join the waiting list, and nobody is moved up from it, so what you see 3 hours out is what turns up. Gloucester asked for a booking cut-off in early September for exactly this reason; until now it existed but was switched off, so bookings ran right up to the whistle.

WHAT MEMBERS WILL NOTICE

CANCELLING VERY LATE NO LONGER EARNS A REFUND

Your cancellation policy already says that inside **24 hours** a member only gets their credit back if somebody else takes their spot. That has not changed — but it now has a consequence worth knowing about.

Because a spot freed inside 3 hours is no longer passed to the waiting list, there is nobody to take it, so a member who cancels that late **keeps no credit and frees no seat**. Before this change they would usually have been refunded, precisely because the next person was being charged.

Cancel earlier than 3 hours and everything works as it always has.

A 19:30 session, for a member cancelling at different times

CANCELS AT	WAITING LIST	THE MEMBER'S CREDIT
Two days before	Next person booked and charged	Refunded in full
15:00 — 4h 30m before	Next person booked and charged	Refunded in full
17:00 — 2h 30m before	Untouched, nobody charged	Not refunded
19:00 — 30m before	Untouched, nobody charged	Not refunded

WHAT HOSTS SHOULD KNOW ON THE NIGHT

Once a session is locked, a cancellation leaves a gap and the app does not fill it. What that means in practice:

- **Nobody can take the spot.** Booking is closed and the waiting list is frozen, so it stays empty.
- **Nobody is told it opened, including you.** No email goes out, because nobody is promoted. The booked list in the dashboard shows the free place, so check it before you set the courts out.
- **How you cover a gap on the night is your call for now.** We have not settled how a spot freed inside the lock should be filled, so the app deliberately does nothing with it.
- **A comp is not a way round it.** Comping only works for people who are themselves club admins, so it cannot be used to let an ordinary member in.

CHANGING IT FOR YOUR CLUB

Admin › Settings › General › “Lock sessions before the start”

One switch and one number, set to **3 hours** at both clubs. You can choose anything from 1 to 24 hours. The ceiling is 24 because that is where your cancellation policy starts: inside it a member is only refunded if somebody takes their spot, and inside the lock nobody can — which is what makes “cancel after the lock and you lose the fee” always true. Switching it off returns to the old behaviour: bookings open to the start, and a freed spot handed to the waiting list and charged at any time.

NOT DECIDED YET

What should happen to a spot that frees up inside the lock. The options range from leaving it to the host on the night to offering it round the waiting list, and we would rather settle it with you than guess. Since booking opened in late August not one cancellation has landed inside 3 hours, so there is time to get it right — but if you see it happening, tell us, because that is what will decide it.
